

F1 Atlas Logic — nodes, views and groupings

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Scope

This pass settles the Atlas's logic before the next deep dives fill it. It answers five questions:

1. Should F1 group the world by civilisation?
2. What other groupings exist, and which should the Atlas use?
3. What is a node, and what is a view?
4. Which of the eleven views can merge?
5. Should movements and other groupings get their own storytelling view?

It also sets how much each view shows at each depth.

It starts from the node model in [F1 Deep Dives 1 §3](#). There, every node shares one card, and era, material, function and movement are relations between nodes rather than properties of an object. The eleven views under review are those listed in decision 16: map, globe, timeline, occurrences, connections, movements, inventions, compare, story, lineage and calendars.

Assumed while the questions are open. Q1–Q6 from Deep Dives 1 and P1–P11 from the groundwork are applied as recommended. In particular, the coverage floor and the two new world chapters (Q1) are assumed, because the groupings have to reach them.

How others group the world's making

No major resource groups world making by civilisation alone. Museums group by region and period. Datasets group by polity, period definition or entity class. Historians group by network, horizon or culture area. Each grouping answers a different question and hides something else, so the Atlas needs several kinds of grouping, each labelled for what it is.

Resource	Groups by	Good for	Weak for	What F1 takes
The Met's Heilbrunn Timeline	Region × period: about fifty sub-regions, each with its own chronology	Coverage; seeing what was made at the same time elsewhere	Each cell hides the routes between cells	The coverage grid (Deep Dives 1 §2); a "meanwhile elsewhere" list on every period
Smarthistory	Place (six continents), then chronology, plus curated guides; written by over 850 specialists	Readable expert essays	Continents as containers	Ring 2 links for Practice-depth reading
The British Museum and BBC, A History of the World in 100 Objects (2010)	Twenty time bands of five objects, each band framed as a question for the whole world	One object per place per era; a global question per band	A hundred objects is sparse	The time band with a question, as a story form for period nodes
Google Arts & Culture	Facets: artists, mediums, art movements, historical events, historical figures, places	Faceted browsing across millions of items	"Art movements" follows Western art history	Facets become lenses; movement becomes one grouping kind among many
Linked Art (CIDOC-CRM)	Entities and events: objects, people and groups, places, concepts, periods, production activities	A shared data backbone with museum records	Not a teaching structure	The relation model (Deep Dives 1 §3)

Resource	Groups by	Good for	Weak for	What F1 takes
PeriodO	Periods as scholarly definitions, each tied to the source that defined it, with its own place and span	Treating periods as claims, not facts; public domain	Not a narrative	The period node is a definition by a source; one label can have several definitions
Seshat and Cliopatria	Polities: Seshat codes over 500; Cliopatria maps polity borders from 3400 BCE to 2024 CE	A political map that changes over time	States only; stateless peoples and their making drop out	A polity grouping and a borders layer, with that limit stated on screen
Wikidata	Classes: civilisation, archaeological culture, art movement, historical period, dynasty, historical country	Identifiers that join every dataset above	Classes used inconsistently	Identifiers and Ring 3 browsing
Culture areas (Wissler and Kroeber, early 20th century)	Contiguous regions sharing traits and environments; the idea began as a way to arrange museum displays	Linking making to environment	Boundaries criticised as arbitrary and static	An environment lens (biomes), not territory boxes

Resource	Groups by	Good for	Weak for	What F1 takes
Archaeological horizons	A style found across a wide area within a short time, such as the Andes' Early, Middle and Late Horizons (Chavín; Wari and Tiwanaku; Inca)	Influence across polities	Tells little about makers	A "horizon" grouping kind
World-systems history, e.g. Abu-Lughod, Before European Hegemony (1989)	Overlapping trade circuits linking Flanders to China, about 1250–1350	Networks as the unit of history	Makers appear as traders' goods	The network grouping behind F1.13
Civilisational schemes: Toynbee (21 civilisations and five "arrested" ones); Huntington (the "highest cultural grouping of people")	Large, bounded cultural wholes	Familiar words; the big picture	Essentialist, ranked, prone to "rise and fall"	Taught in F1.3 as historiography, not used to structure the Atlas

Resource	Groups by	Good for	Weak for	What F1 takes
Graeber and Wengrow, <i>The Dawn of Everything</i> (2021)	No single grouping; they argue there was "no single original form of human society" and that neighbours often defined themselves against each other	Groupings as relations people chose, not containers	Not a data model	Membership in any grouping is a claim with a confidence, and may be contested

What the benchmarks agree on. The strongest resources group in more than one way at once. Place and time come first, and every grouping beyond them is labelled for what kind of grouping it is and who defined it.

Civilisations

The word belongs in F1, but as a label learners search for and a subject F1 teaches, not as the frame the Atlas is built on. Used as a frame, it would drop exactly the makers F1 is meant to recover: the foragers who made pottery 20,000 years ago, Pacific navigators, steppe metalworkers, Nok's farming communities.

The case for it

- Learners, museums and heritage listings use it: "Maya civilisation", "Indus Valley civilisation". A learner who cannot find those names will think they are missing.
- It names something real at a large scale: scripts, cities, monumental building and styles that lasted for centuries across many polities.
- It gives newcomers a first handhold before the finer groupings.

The case against it

- **It was built to rank.** The word was coined in French in 1757 and set against "barbarism". It was later used to justify colonial rule; settlers in Australia, for example, claimed Indigenous Australians were "not civilised enough" to own the land ([summary with sources](#)).

- **It makes cities and writing the entry ticket.** Childe's criteria for civilisation (cities, surplus, writing, specialists) turn the recurrences of F1.5 into a test some peoples pass and others fail.
- **It excludes great makers.** The Frankfurt project found that Nok was made by semi-sedentary farming communities organised mainly around families, not by a complex state ([DFG summary](#)). Nok still produced one of Africa's great sculptural traditions. Making does not need a civilisation.
- **It implies bounded wholes that rise and fall.** That hides the networks (F1.13) and the living practices that outlast any state (Igum Street, Great Zimbabwe's masonry).
- **Recent scholarship moved away from it.** Graeber and Wengrow argue there was "no single original form of human society", and that large, complex societies lived for millennia without central rulers.

Three ways F1 could use the word

Option	What it means	Gains	Costs
A. Civilisation as the main organiser	The Atlas and the world chapters are built from named civilisations	Familiar; easy to search	Ranks and excludes; contradicts F1.3, F1.5 and F1.6
B. A labelled grouping kind and a search name (recommended)	Well-known names exist as "civilisation, as commonly named" and open onto the groupings underneath; F1.3 teaches the word's history	Learners find what they look for, then see how it is built	Needs a caveat card and careful copy
C. Drop the word	Only the precise groupings are used	Clean	Learners cannot find "Maya civilisation"; the history of the word goes untaught

How option B works. Each common civilisation name opens a card that shows what it is made of and what it leaves out.

Common name	What sits underneath	What the card says is left out
Indus Valley civilisation	An archaeological culture (Harappan) and its phases; cities; an undeciphered script (F1.5)	Its neighbours; whether the signs are writing
Egyptian civilisation	A polity with dynasties; periods defined by Egyptologists; the Nile valley	Nubia and Kush, which Egypt fought, traded with and was ruled by
Maya civilisation	A culture area of city-states, a writing system, periods (Preclassic to Postclassic)	Present-day Maya communities and their making
Andean civilisation	Horizons (Chavín; Wari and Tiwanaku; Inca) and the polities between them	The coast and the Amazon slopes (the Upano cities)
Chinese civilisation	Many polities and dynasties, with a script that ran through them	Peoples at the edges, and the steppe
Islamic civilisation	A belief tradition and a network of cities and routes (F1.10)	Non-Muslim makers within it, and its African and Asian peripheries
Greek and Roman civilisation	Polities, a shared material horizon around the Mediterranean	Enslaved makers; the North African and West Asian halves of the Roman world
Swahili civilisation	A coastal network of towns trading across the Indian Ocean	The interior that supplied it (Great Zimbabwe's gold)

The rules that go with it. A civilisation card is never ranked against another. It carries no "rise and fall" story unless the evidence supports that story. It always links to the peoples next to it who were not part of it. And the word never appears in the Atlas's own navigation, only as a searchable label.

The grouping families

F1 can use twenty kinds of grouping, in seven families. Every grouping is a node with the common card, plus four things of its own: its **kind**; **who defined it** (an archaeologist, a museum, the members themselves); **membership** as a relation with its own confidence;

and **what it leaves out**. Groupings overlap and nest. One Benin plaque belongs at once to a polity (the Kingdom of Benin), a maker community (the Igun Eronmwon guild), a material family (copper alloy), a technique (lost-wax casting), a network (the Atlantic brass route) and a period (1500s–1600s).

Family	Kind	Membership rule	Defined by	Example in F1	Shown in
Place	World region and sub-region	Where the thing was made or found	F1, after the Heilbrunn regions	West Africa: Guinea Coast	Map; coverage grid
Place	Culture area	Shared traits within a contiguous area	Anthropologists and museums	The Maya area	Map; grouping view
Place	Environment (biome)	The setting that shaped the making: desert, steppe, rainforest, ocean, mountain, river, ice	F1, from environmental data	Pacific ocean making; steppe felt	Map lens
Time	Period	A span defined by a named source for a named region	Specialists; gazetteered by PeriodO	Heian; Classic Maya; Nok's three phases	Timeline
Time	Period band	F1's eleven global bands, for coverage and comparison only	F1	1000 BCE–1 CE	Timeline; coverage grid
Time	Age	A technology sequence (Stone, Bronze, Iron), always tied to the region it was defined for	Archaeologists, region by region	The Iron Age of the Sahel	Timeline, with its region shown
Time	Horizon	One style spread widely in a short time	Archaeologists	The Andes' Middle Horizon (Wari, Tiwanaku)	Map and timeline together

Family	Kind	Membership rule	Defined by	Example in F1	Shown in
People	Polity	Ruled by, or living under, a state, kingdom, empire or city-state	Historians; Seshat and Cliopatria	The Kingdom of Benin; the Kushite kingdom	Map borders layer
People	Dynasty	Made under a ruling house	Historians	Shang; Mamluk	Timeline
People	Archaeological culture	Shared material traits in excavated sites	Archaeologists	Nok; Vinča; Lapita	Map; grouping view
People	Community or people	Self-identified group, named in its own terms first	The community	The Edo; the Haya	Grouping view, with protocol
People	Maker community	Trained or working together: guild, workshop, caste, lineage, cooperative	The makers, or records of them	The Igun Eronmwon guild; the Mughal karkhana	Lineage; grouping view
People	Belief tradition	Made for or within a religion or practice	Specialists and practitioners	Buddhist printing; Ethiopian Christianity	Grouping view
Ideas	Movement	Declared itself, with a programme and members	Its members	Arts and Crafts; Mingei; the Bauhaus	Grouping view
Ideas	Style	A formal family, usually named later	Historians	Gothic; Chavín style	Compare; grouping view
Ideas	School	Passed from teacher to pupil	Records and practitioners	Kano school painting	Lineage
Connections	Network	Linked by routes of goods, materials, skills or people	Historians	The Indian Ocean; the Atlantic	Globe; connections

Family	Kind	Membership rule	Defined by	Example in F1	Shown in
Connections	Interaction sphere or diaspora	Linked by shared exchange or by people who moved	Archaeologists and historians	Swahili coast towns; the Sogdian merchants	Connections; grouping view
Things	Material, technique, function and object type	Made of, made with, made for, made as	Getty AAT; F1's function list	Copper alloy; lost-wax casting; storage; bowls	Lenses on every view
Composite	Civilisation, as commonly named	A searchable name that opens onto the groupings beneath it (§3)	Common usage	Indus Valley civilisation	Search; grouping view with a caveat card

Two rules that keep groupings honest

- **Ages belong to regions.** The Stone, Bronze and Iron Age sequence was built on European evidence. Indigenous American makers did not smelt iron before European contact, and F1.6 shows iron following stone in much of Africa. An age label always carries the region it was defined for, like any other period.
- **Membership can be contested.** Cleveland's Nok head is placed in a "Nok-culture style region", yet its date falls after Nok ends. When membership is argued, the relation shows the contested line, exactly as a claim would.

Functions deserve their own list. You asked about grouping by function, and no standard list fits making across all of history. F1's working list has twelve: shelter, clothing and adornment, food and storage, tools, record and writing, exchange and value, ritual and belief, rule and display, war, play and music, care and access, and transport. It is used as a lens and tested in the deep dives.

Nodes, groupings, views, lenses and stories

Your question was whether nodes and views play different roles. They do. Nodes are the content: things, places, people and ideas, each with its own card. Views are layouts of that content. Groupings sit in between: they are nodes in their own right, and they also gather other nodes, so a grouping can be read as a page and used as a filter.

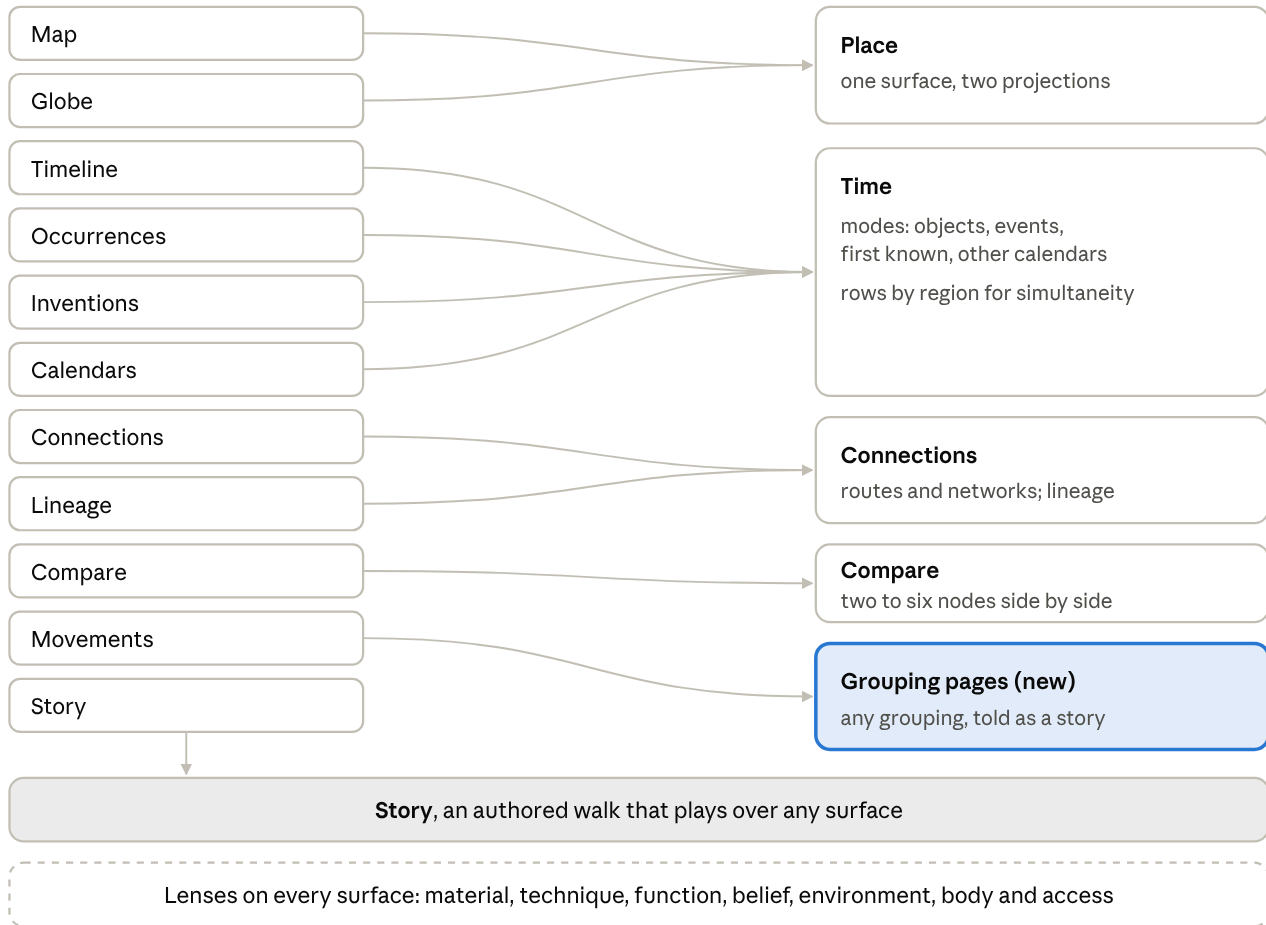
Term	What it is	Example
Node	One thing with its own identity and card	The Benin plaque; Meroë; lost-wax casting
Grouping	A node whose members are other nodes; any of the twenty kinds in §4	The Igun Eronmwon guild; Mingei; the Indian Ocean
Relation	A typed link between two nodes, with its own source and confidence	Made of copper alloy (documented)
Surface	A layout of nodes by one kind of relation (what decision 16 called a view)	Place lays out "made at"
Mode	A setting of a surface	Time in "first known" mode
Lens	A filter or colouring applied to any surface	Function: storage
Story	An authored walk through nodes that plays over any surface	F1.6's eight steps

Which views merge. Most of the eleven views are the same layout with different settings. Merging them gives learners fewer places to learn and fewer screens to build.

Eleven views become five surfaces, a story layer and lenses

Views in decision 16

Surfaces proposed here



the eleven views of decision 16 mapped onto the proposed surfaces

- **Place** joins the map and the globe. They show the same relation ("made at", "found at", "held at") in two projections; the globe is the projection for oceans and long routes.
- **Time** joins the timeline, occurrences, inventions and calendars. Occurrences are events on the same scale; inventions become a "first known" mode that obeys the "earliest known" rule; calendars are a change of scale. F1.5's simultaneity view is Time with one row per region.
- **Connections** joins connections and lineage. Both are graphs; lineage filters to "learned from", "copied from" and "descends from".
- **Compare** stays as it is: two to six nodes side by side, read through the same six readings.
- **Grouping pages** replace the movements view, and they cover every kind of grouping, not only movements (§6).

- **Story** becomes a layer rather than a view: the same walk can move across the map, down the timeline and into a grouping page.
- **Lenses** apply everywhere. They carry the groupings of the Things family (material, technique, function, object type), plus belief, environment and the body-and-access lens from sprint 6.

What ships first. Place, Time (objects and events), Connections (routes), Story and Grouping pages. The globe projection, Compare, the "first known" and calendar modes, and lineage follow by version. This replaces gate question C1's "six views first", and it stays within the same build size.

On the phone. Place, Time, Grouping pages and Story. Connections becomes a list of links, and Compare is kept for the desk.

The grouping page: a story for every grouping

Yes, major movements should have their own view, and so should cultures, networks, guilds, horizons and civilisation names. One page design serves all of them. Each page tells its grouping as a story, and each step lights up the grouping's members on a small map and timeline beside the text.

What every grouping page holds

1. **The card.** Its kind, who defined it and when, its span and places, how sure membership is, and what it leaves out.
2. **The walk.** 6–9 authored steps through its members, in order. Each step moves the small map and timeline, and any step can open the full Place, Time or Connections surface.
3. **Members.** Every member node as a grid, filterable by any lens (material, function, belief...), with contested members marked.
4. **Neighbours and counterparts.** The groupings it defined itself against, and the parallel groupings elsewhere.
5. **Afterlives.** Revivals, living practice, and how it is sold or remembered today.
6. **What is argued.** The claims under dispute, both readings shown.
7. **Apply hook.** The task in the unit that uses it.

Worked example: Mingei, a movement

Part	Content
Card	Movement; named by Yanagi Sōetsu in the mid-1920s; Japan, 1920s–1950s and after; members documented; leaves out the anonymous makers it championed, who did not choose the label
1	Korean ceramics, 1910s: Yanagi and fellow collectors value Joseon wares; the movement's first ideas are formed on another country's craft
2	The word, mid-1920s: <i>mingei</i> , "folk crafts"; a 1926 prospectus for a museum
3	The unknown maker: the ideal of beauty in everyday things by anonymous rural craftspeople
4	Named makers: the potters Hamada Shōji and Kawai Kanjirō, and the potter Bernard Leach, as the movement's public faces
5	The museum, 1936: the Japan Folk Crafts Museum in Komaba, Tokyo, designed by Yanagi
6	Collecting across an empire: journeys to Korea (1936–37) and Okinawa (1938–39)
7	The argument: historians such as Kim Brandt read Mingei as entangled with Japanese imperial policy; others stress its resistance to industrial uniformity
Neighbours	Arts and Crafts in Britain (its acknowledged source); parallel craft revivals elsewhere, set side by side in Compare
Afterlives	Studio pottery worldwide; "mingei" as a design and retail label today
Sources	SamuraiWiki summary with references ; review of Brandt, <i>Kingdom of Beauty</i> (to be replaced by the museum's own and scholarly sources in the unit spec)

The tension between step 3 and step 4 carries the lesson: a movement that praised the unknown maker became famous through named ones. Brandt's reviewer flags the same conflict.

The same page, other kinds

Grouping	Kind	Where the walk goes	What the card warns
Nok	Archaeological culture	From the tin mines where terracottas were first found, to the Frankfurt excavations, to the three phases, to the looting	Membership of museum pieces is often contested; the date of Cleveland's head falls outside Nok
The Igun Eronmwon guild	Maker community	Oral history of its founding, the Oba's patronage, 1897, the return to Igun Street, the guild today	The guild's own account comes first; museum records second
The Middle Horizon	Horizon	Wari and Tiwanaku, the tapestry tunic (the Met's Wari tunic, WS-007), roads and shared imagery	A horizon is a spread of style, not an empire
Indus Valley civilisation	Civilisation, as commonly named	Its cities, weights and seals, the signs and the argument over them, then its neighbours	What the name hides; the card links to the groupings underneath (§3)
The Indian Ocean	Network	The monsoon, ports, cotton and ceramics, people who moved, and those moved by force	Human movement is never drawn as goods (the sprint 5 rule)

Which groupings get a page. Ring 1 gets full pages, with a walk, for every grouping a unit teaches: about 60 across F1, counting roughly five per world chapter, a dozen movements and schools, six networks and a dozen civilisation cards. Ring 2 gets a card and a member grid without a walk, for any grouping with at least five verified members and a source. Ring 3 gets a card that links out to Wikidata or PeriodO.

How much each surface shows at each depth

The Atlas grows with the learner rather than showing everything at once. At Orientation it shows a few dozen things with a line each. At Mastery it shows everything, with its sources and arguments. The rule underneath is the node card's four tiers (Deep Dives 1 §3): Orientation reads the line and label, Practice adds the story, Mastery adds the deep text and the claims.

Surface	Orientation	Practice	Mastery
Place	The 60 Ring 1 objects as pins, a line on hover	Ring 2 nodes added; labels; one lens at a time	Ring 3 through search; the polity borders layer; each relation's source and confidence
Time	Eleven period bands with two or three anchor objects each	Every Ring 1 and 2 node; events; rows by region	Competing period definitions (PeriodO); "first known" mode with its claims; other calendars
Connections	Three routes, told as F1.13's story	Networks with goods, materials, skills and people as separate layers	The full graph; lineage; provenance edges; export
Compare	Not shown	Two or three nodes, three readings	Up to six nodes, six readings, with claims
Grouping pages	The card, the line and three members	The walk, the members and the neighbours	What is argued; sources; membership confidence; links out
Story	Walks of five steps	Walks of six to nine steps	Learners write their own walks (F1.27, Atlas authoring)

Rules that keep it readable

- No more than seven colours or categories on screen at once.
- One lens at a time at Orientation; up to three at Mastery.
- Each Orientation unit introduces at most one new surface.

- Pins cluster beyond about 60 on screen, and clusters open on tap.
- Every surface has a list alternative with the same content, for screen readers and for anyone who prefers reading to looking (the Accessibility thread).

Decisions and what changes

#	Decision	Recommendation
Q7	How F1 uses "civilisation"	As a labelled grouping kind and a search name, never as the Atlas's frame; F1.3 teaches the word's history (option B, §3)
Q8	The grouping families	Adopt the twenty kinds, each with its kind, who defined it, membership confidence and what it leaves out; ages always tied to a region (§4)
Q9	Merging the views	Eleven views become five surfaces (Place, Time, Connections, Compare, Grouping pages), a story layer and lenses. Ship first: Place, Time, Connections, Story and Grouping pages. This replaces C1 (§5)
Q10	Grouping pages	One page design for every kind of grouping, not only movements; about 60 full pages at Ring 1 (§6)
Q11	Grouping by function	Adopt the twelve-function list as a lens, tested in the deep dives (§4)
Q12	Density by depth	Adopt the table and the five readability rules (§7)

What changes if these are agreed

- The Atlas design moves to v2. The parts of F1 Pass 2 v2 §2–§3 that list eleven views are marked superseded.
- The mockups get a new iteration: the view switcher becomes Place, Time, Connections and Groupings, and a grouping-page artboard is added (Mingei on the desk, Nok on the phone).
- F1.3 gains a case, "civilisation as an argument", running from 1757 to Huntington to Graeber and Wengrow.
- The Glossary gains grouping, surface, lens, horizon, culture area, polity, archaeological culture and period definition.

- PeriodO and Cliopatria join the data sources as Ring 2 and Ring 3.
- The deep dives in F1 Deep Dives 2 already use the grouping kinds, so each world names its groupings by kind.